

Question no. 01:

What is an Islamic State? Define it and list its basic and unique features.

Answer:

A state is an organized society governed by a high authority based on mutual obedience and rule. An Islamic State is one where complete sovereignty belongs to Allah alone, the supreme law is the Quran and Sunnah, all affairs are decided through consultation (Shura), and it is an ideological state that does not discriminate on grounds of color, race, language, or ethnicity.

Islamic Response:

“Lo! His is the creation and His is the command. Blessed is Allah, the Lord of the universe.”

خبردار! تخلیق اور حکم صرف اسی کا ہے۔ بابرکت ہے اللہ جو تمام جہانوں کا رب ہے۔

| (Al-A'raf; 7:54)

“All authority to govern rests only with Allah. He has commanded that you serve none but Him. This is the Right Way of life.”

حکم صرف اللہ ہی کا ہے۔ اس نے حکم دیا ہے کہ تم اس کے سوا کسی کی عبادت نہ کرو۔ یہی سیدھا دین ہے۔

| (Yusuf; 12:40)

Question no. 02:

Explain Allah's Sovereignty and the role of Shari'ah as the Supreme Law. What is the order of obedience in an Islamic State?

Answer:

Allah is the only Creator, Sustainer and Master of the universe — so He alone has the right to rule in all spheres of human life. Shari'ah (Quran and Sunnah) is the supreme law; no one can legislate against it. The order of obedience is: Allah first, then His Messenger, then those in authority — but only as long as they obey Allah and His Prophet.

Islamic Response:

“Those who do not judge by what Allah has revealed are indeed the unbelievers.”

اور جو لوگ اللہ کے نازل کردہ احکام کے مطابق فیصلہ نہ کریں وہی کافر ہیں۔

| (Al-Ma'idah; 5:44)

“O you who believe, obey Allah and obey the Messenger and those charged with authority among you; if you differ in anything among yourselves, refer it to Allah and His Messenger.”

اے ایمان والو! اللہ کی اطاعت کرو اور رسول کی اطاعت کرو اور ان میں سے صاحبانِ اختیار کی بھی۔ اگر کسی معاملے میں اختلاف ہو تو اسے اللہ اور اس کے رسول کی طرف لوٹاؤ۔

| (Al-Nisa'; 4:59)

The Prophet Muhammad ﷺ said:

نبی اکرم ﷺ نے فرمایا

“There is no obedience to the creation if it entails the disobedience of the Creator.”

مخلوق کی اطاعت جائز نہیں اگر اس میں خالق کی نافرمانی ہو۔

| (Al-Mu'jam al-Kabir, al-Tabarani; 381)

Question no. 03:

What is Khilafat (Vicegerency)? How does it differ from kingship? What are the qualifications of those in authority?

Answer:

When Allah created mankind, He made them His deputies (Caliphs) on Earth. Khilafat is not hereditary kingship or theocracy — it is the collective right of all those who accept Allah's sovereignty and adopt the Divine Code as supreme law. A Khalifah is elected through consultation, is accountable to Allah and the public, enforces justice, and can be removed. A monarch, by contrast, rules by force without such accountability.

Islamic Response:

“Just think when your Lord said to the angels: Lo! I am about to place a vicegerent on earth.”

اور یاد کرو جب تمہارے رب نے فرشتوں سے کہا: میں زمین میں ایک خلیفہ بنانے والا ہوں۔

| (Al-Baqarah; 2:30)

“Allah has promised to those among you who believe and work righteous deeds that He will grant them Khilafah in the land, as He granted it to those before them.”

اللہ نے وعدہ کیا ہے تم میں سے ان لوگوں کے ساتھ جو ایمان لائے اور نیک عمل کیے کہ وہ انہیں زمین میں خلیفہ ضرور بنائے گا جیسا کہ ان سے پہلوں کو بنایا۔

| (Al-Nur; 24:55)

The Prophet Muhammad ﷺ said:

نبی اکرم ﷺ نے فرمایا

“When the government is entrusted to undeserving people, then wait for the Last Day.”

جب امانتیں اہل لوگوں کے بجائے نااہلوں کے سپرد کر دی جائیں تو قیامت کا انتظار کرو۔

| (Sahih Al-Bukhari; 59)

Question no. 04:

Explain Shura (Consultation) as a binding principle in the Islamic State. What are its principles?

Answer:

Shura (mutual consultation) is a fundamental pillar of the Islamic State. Even the Prophet ﷺ was commanded to consult his companions in public matters. The Quran makes consultation a defining characteristic of the believers. Its key principles include: free expression of opinion, consent free from coercion, advisers being pious and knowledgeable, and accepting the consensus or majority view.

Islamic Response:

“Who conduct their affairs by mutual consultation and spend out of what We have bestowed upon them.”

اور جو انے معاملات باہمی مشورے سے چلاتے ہیں اور جو رزق ہم نے انہیں دیا ہے اس میں سے خرچ کرتے ہیں۔

| (Al-Shura; 42:38)

“And take counsel from them in matters of importance; then when you have decided, put your trust in Allah.”

اور معاملات میں ان سے مشورہ کر، پھر جب تو عزم کر لے تو اللہ پر توکل کر۔

| (Al 'Imran; 3:159)

Question no. 05:

What are the responsibilities of an Islamic Welfare State? What are the rights and obligations of citizens?

Answer:

The Islamic State is responsible for: preserving Din, enforcing Shari'ah and justice, securing territory, collecting and distributing Zakat, appointing competent officials, and protecting public welfare. As a welfare state it must eradicate poverty, maintain law and order, ensure social and economic justice, and provide social security.

Citizens in return must obey the state, be law-abiding, and be prepared to defend it.

Islamic Response:

“Those who, if We give them authority in the land, establish Prayer, give Zakat, enjoin good and forbid evil.”

یہ وہ لوگ ہیں کہ اگر ہم انہیں زمین میں اقتدار دیں تو وہ نماز قائم کریں، زکوٰۃ دیں، نیکی کا حکم دیں اور برائی سے روکیں۔

| (Al-Hajj; 22:41)

“Indeed, Allah commands justice, grace, as well as courtesy to close relatives. He forbids indecency, wickedness, and aggression.”

بے شک اللہ عدل، احسان اور قربت داروں کو دینے کا حکم دیتا ہے اور فحاشی، برائی اور سرکشی سے منع کرتا ہے۔

| (Al-Nahl; 16:90)

The Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) said:

نبی اکرم ﷺ نے فرمایا

“Tell them that Allah has made the payment of Zakat obligatory upon them. It should be collected from their rich and distributed among their poor.”

انہیں بتاؤ کہ اللہ نے ان پر زکوٰۃ فرض کی ہے۔ جو ان کے مالداروں سے لی جائے اور ان کے غریبوں میں تقسیم کی جائے۔

| (Sahih Al-Bukhari; 1395)

“And in their wealth, there was a rightful share for him who would ask and for the destitute.”

اور ان کے مالوں میں مانگنے والوں اور محروموں کا حق تھا۔

| (Al-Dhariyat; 51:19)